



when the Wi-Fi alliance made a pitch for UNII-4, it was finally granted. The wireless spectrum is broken down for use by different industries and different technologies. The 5 GHz band is also used by RADAR applications and RADAR gets priority over Wi-Fi. So when a Wi-Fi system detects RADAR being used, it has to pause the channels on UNII-2 and UNII-2e frequency ranges so that there is no interference. This means that your Wi-Fi connection could be paused at any time if RADAR signals are detected. UNII-4 is not shared with RADAR. So no matter what,

it will always remain connected. It can also host an entire 160 MHz channel. The best performance of a Wi-Fi 6 router can only be achieved on 160 MHz wide channel so you get that added advantage. But like always, you need support for UNII-4 on both ends, client and server, for this to work.

PERFORMANCE

Setting up the GT-AX11000 Pro was a breeze. The quick setup guide is always useful and you can be ready to go in no time. That being said, the router does give you the freedom to tweak every

single feature so for folks who prefer to get their hands dirty with the nitty-gritties, this is an excellent router. Once set up properly, the ROG Rapture GT-AX11000 Pro ends up being a top-notch router in terms of performance.

On the 5 GHz band with a 2T2R client, the GT-AX11000 Pro can easily attain 1560 Mbps on both 5 GHz bands. The signal degradation over our farthest test zones is also not too much. We could not test the UNII-4 range since we did not have any clients that were compatible. On the 2.4 GHz band, we ended up getting about 230 Mbps on a 2T2R client. This isn't exactly top-notch but it was competitive. Also, signal degradation wasn't bad either.

VERDICT

The ASUS ROG Rapture GT-AX11000 Pro stands as a robust and feature-rich router, excelling in its role as a tri-band Wi-Fi 6 device. Its advanced features, such as the additional 10 Gbps LAN port and UNII-4 support, set it apart from its predecessor, the GT-AX11000. Its performance is right up there at the top of the leaderboard and it's also future-proof to an extent thanks to the open-source firmware and support for UNII-4. That being said, we're looking at Wi-Fi 6E and 7 routers hitting the market soon. So consumers have a choice between being an early adopter for Wi-Fi 7 or picking a very stable Wi-Fi 6 device. It's your choice. For Rs. 53,369 this isn't exactly a cheap router since most flagships in the past used to be in the 25-30K range. For the same amount, you can get a Wi-Fi 7 router with a cumulative bandwidth of 24.4 Gbps. That would be relatively more future-proof.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

SoC: Broadcom BCM4912 | WLAN1: BCM6715 | WLAN2: BCM6715 | LAN: 4x Gigabit Ethernet | WAN: 1x 2.5 GbE + 1x 10 GbE | USB Ports: 2 | Antennae: 8x External | WPS: Yes | Protocols: 802.11ax (11000 Mbps).

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